

Checking your bladder You will be asked whether you have any problems urinating, and may be asked for a urine sample if you have symptoms such as frequent urination or stinging when passing urine. Stress incontinence, or leaking urine (see [Bladder problems](#)), is common after childbirth, so don't feel embarrassed to mention it.

You may be encouraged to do pelvic floor exercises, or [Kegel exercises](#). If the problem persists, you may be referred to a physical therapist for bladder-training exercises.

Your stitches If you're still sore from stitches, your doctor will check that these are healing properly. Although most stitches are absorbable, they can take up to three months to completely absorb. Bathing can sometimes help the stitches absorb, but if you continue to have problems your doctor may recommend Sitz baths two or three times a day or a topical anesthetic cream (see also [Perineal problems](#)).



Your postpartum checkup is the ideal time to talk to your doctor about any problems or concerns you have, and to receive reassurance that you have recovered well after the birth.

Your emotional well-being

In addition to checking you physically, the doctor will assess your emotional and mental health. Many women feel extremely tired in these early weeks, as night feedings and constant demands begin to take their toll. However, if you are feeling low, overly